

Sunless Dunes



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VETALAS

Vetalas (वेताल) or Betalas are colorful vampiric undead fey from the northern undead wastes of Eqos. Knowledgeable entities, they haunt graveyards, charnel grounds, crematoriums, cremation ghats, and dead forests. Vetalas can possess corpses and reanimate them to serve as their vehicles, and are often found hanging upside down from trees. Many of their abilities and weaknesses are the same as other vampires, however it is said that more than blood, a vetala desires knowledge and souls. In the Kav'orra Desert, vetalas are a common source of fear near cremation grounds. While it's rare to actually encounter one, every child grows up hearing the stories and legends about these

monsters. Vetalas are known to be evil yet mischievous, somewhat like dark fey. They like to drive mortals mad, trick them into serving their will, and offer knowledge in exchange for souls. Through Gunradev, they have a vast amount of knowledge about history as well as the future, and a deep insight into human nature. Many mages have tried to capture them and turn them into their servants for just this reason. Sometimes, vetalas would make bargains with villages and mortals, agreeing to guard them from outsiders in exchange for sacrifices as well as the corpses of the deceased. These deals are dangerous, as vetalas have been known to kill children or cause miscarriages if the mortals fail to meet their end of the obligations.

VETALA

Medium Undead, Chaotic Evil

AC 15 **Initiative** +4 (14)

HP 115 (14d8 + 52)

Speed 40 ft., Climb 40 ft., Fly 20 ft.

MOD SAVE			MOD SAVE			MOD SAVE		
STR	18	+4 +4	DEX	18	+4 +7	CON	16	+3 +6
INT	18	+4 +4	WIS	14	+2 +5	CHA	16	+3 +6

Skills History +7, Insight +5, Perception +5, Stealth +7

Resistances Psychic

Immunities Cold, Necrotic; Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened

Senses Darkvision 120 ft.; Passive Perception 15

Languages The languages it knew in life

CR 8 (XP 3,900; PB +3)

TRAITS

Multitype. The vetala has two creature types: Undead and Fey. If either of its creature types is affected by a game mechanic, it is affected by it as well.

Funerary Rites. A Cleric or Paladin can use their Bonus Action to attempt a DC 15 Wisdom (Religion) check. On a success, they discern the proper funerary rites needed to weaken the vetala. They can then use an Action to perform the rites, provided they can see the vetala and are within 30 feet of it, causing it to take 22 (5d8) Radiant damage. Once the vetala loses Hit Points as a result of this rite, it cannot be affected by the rite again until the start of its next turn.

Sunlight Hypersensitivity. The vetala takes 10 Radiant damage when it starts its turn in sunlight. While in sunlight, it has Disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks.

Undead Nature. The vetala doesn't need air, food, drink, or sleep.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The vetala makes two Claw attacks followed by one Bite attack.

Claw. *Melee Attack Roll:* +7, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) Slashing damage, plus 5 (1d10) Necrotic damage. On a hit, the vetala can forgo dealing damage and instead grapple the target (escape DC 15). While Grappled in this way, the target's movement speed is halved as the vetala clings to their back. The vetala can only grapple one creature at a time.

Bite. *Melee Attack Roll:* +7, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) Piercing damage, plus 9 (2d8) Necrotic damage. The target's Hit Point maximum decreases by an amount equal to the Necrotic damage taken, and the vetala regains Hit Points equal to that amount.

Ominous Whispers (Recharge 5–6). *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 15, each creature within 30 feet of the vetala that can hear it. *Failure:* 27 (6d8) Psychic damage, and the creature has the Frightened condition for 1 minute, and it repeats the save at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. *Success:* Half damage only.

BONUS ACTIONS

Possess Corpse (1/Day). The vetala targets a Humanoid corpse within its reach which rises as a Zombie. The Vetala enters and takes full control of the body, retaining its own mental ability scores while using the creature's statistics. The possession lasts until the vetala ends it as a Bonus Action or when the possessed creature drops to 0 Hit Points. When the possession ends, the vetala appears in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the creature.



Enter the world of Abmarah.

Welcome to Sunless Dunes, a new Campaign Setting for D&D 5e and 5.5e inspired by 17th century South-Asia, taking your table to the nation of Kasaaq (कसाक) within the northern deserts of the continent of Eqos. Inside, you will find a setting full of rich Indian-inspired lore, as well as 12 new subclasses, 13 new species, new spells and feats, 30+ unique magical items, and 12+ creature statblocks.



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